

Phillip Kesling

Staff Software Engineer – Engineering Platforms & Data Systems

Greater Madison Area, WI | Open to Remote

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SUMMARY

Staff software engineer specializing in engineering platforms, data systems, and backend architecture. I build trusted platforms that improve developer productivity, strengthen software delivery and engineering visibility, and help teams and leaders make faster, better-informed decisions. My work has supported more than 10,000 engineers across 40+ teams and over 150 products, with impact from engineering operations to executive leadership. Known for turning complex engineering ecosystems into scalable, trusted platforms through strong technical execution and cross-team alignment.

EXPERIENCE

R&D Engineer, Software 6

Broadcom (VMware by Broadcom) · Remote · Nov 2023 – Sep 2025

- Led the data platform and analytics architecture for the Secure Release Platform, an R&D-wide software supply chain audit platform supporting compliance, traceability, and release governance across more than 150 VMware products.
- Built discovery and data layers that made software supply chain relationships visible and auditable across millions of artifacts, enabling targeted vulnerability analysis in hours instead of days of manual investigation across product teams.
- Designed and built a backend and data platform combining APIs, data pipelines, analytical data stores, and query interfaces to unify fragmented software supply chain data at scale.
- Built core Python and Go services that modeled relationships across engineering and release systems, enabling end-to-end release traceability and dependency analysis.
- Partnered with engineering, security, and product teams to define data and system contracts that improved consistency, clarified ownership, and ensured contributed data met downstream product and security requirements.

Staff II Engineer

VMware · Hybrid · Aug 2013 – Nov 2023

- Progressed from Senior MTS to Staff II Engineer while leading architecture and delivery of data platforms, analytics infrastructure, and engineering enablement systems across VMware's R&D organization.
- Built scalable data platforms that unified fragmented software development lifecycle data into consistent, reliable metrics for release tracking, developer productivity, and decision-making from engineering teams to executive leadership.
- Architected VMware's internal R&D data warehouse, defining canonical data models, ingestion patterns, and Python/SQL transformation layers that turned fragmented engineering data into a shared, scalable foundation for self-service analytics, reporting, and downstream applications.

- Built semantic and metrics layers that encoded reusable business and engineering logic on shared data foundations, improving reporting consistency and reducing errors caused by ad hoc interpretation of source system data.
- Frequently brought into ambiguous or at-risk initiatives to clarify requirements, define technical direction, align stakeholders, and create clear delivery paths across organizational boundaries.

R&D Application Development Manager

VMware • On-site • Jan 2008 – Aug 2013

- Led design and evolution of large-scale internal engineering platforms supporting VMware's product quality and release lifecycle, used by thousands of engineers.
- Oversaw platforms supporting test automation, quality analytics, security scanning, and partner enablement across VMware's engineering workflow.
- Established early patterns for platform ownership, automation, and data visibility that later informed broader engineering data and analytics initiatives.

MTS – Lead Developer

VMware • On-site • Apr 2006 – Dec 2007

- Designed and built automation frameworks and internal tools enabling ISV partners and internal teams to validate integrations with VMware software.
- Developed systems supporting test lifecycle management, results aggregation, and reporting across manual and automated workflows.

Software Engineer, Storage

SGI • Mountain View, CA • On-site • 1998 – 2006

- Built automation frameworks and tooling for testing, validating, and supporting high-end storage systems integrated with UNIX and Linux platforms.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages: Python, Go, SQL
- Platform Engineering: Distributed Systems, APIs, Microservices, Platform Architecture, PostgreSQL, Redis
- Data Platforms: Data Modeling, Data Pipelines, Semantic Layers, Kafka, Airflow, dbt, Hive
- Analytics and Observability: Apache Superset, Tableau, Grafana, BI Systems
- AI-Assisted Development: AI-assisted coding, debugging, documentation, and workflow acceleration
- ML Enablement: ML-Ready Datasets, Feature Engineering, Experimentation Support

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Computer Science; Minor in Mathematics
University of Wisconsin–Eau Claire, 1996 – 2000